EVENT INVITATION PLATFORM

Product direction, launch scope, and validation plan

Audience Hosts planning celebrations	**Initial scope** Full guest operations, kept focused
Product Mobile-friendly web app first	**Business model** Pay per event
Market Global-ready, staged launch	**Status** Planning only - no coding yet

Prepared as a planning brief | November 2026

1. Product direction

Working concept: A web-based event invitation and guest-management service where a host creates a polished event page, shares a link, and manages invitations and RSVPs from one dashboard.

The current christening invitation can inspire the visual experience, but the new product should be designed from the beginning to support many hosts and events.

Core promise: One shareable invitation, one place to manage guest responses and event updates.

Audience

- **Hosts** planning birthdays, weddings, christenings, family gatherings, and other celebrations.
- **Co-hosts** who help organize an event and need shared access.
- **Guests** who need a simple, account-free way to view details and RSVP.

Recommended product principle

Design for global use, but launch and support in stages. Global readiness includes time zones, regional date formats, languages, and privacy expectations; it does not require marketing to every country on day one.

2. Host and guest experience

- The host creates an account and starts an event.
- They enter event details, choose a design, and manage the guest list.
- They preview and publish the invitation, then share its link.
- Guests open the link, view the details, and RSVP without creating an account.
- The host tracks responses, sends updates or reminders, and exports the final guest list.

3. Recommended launch scope

Invitation and event setup

- Event name, description, date, time zone, venue, and schedule.
- Mobile-friendly invitation templates with photo and color customization.
- Preview before publishing; public share link and optional unlisted/private link.

Guest management

- Add guests individually or import a list; organize guests into groups.
- Set RSVP status and record party size or plus-ones.
- Search, edit, or remove guest entries; export the guest list.

RSVPs

- Yes, no, or undecided responses, with an optional RSVP deadline.
- Host-defined questions, guest notes, or dietary requirements when enabled.

- Dashboard totals for invited, attending, declined, and awaiting response.

Updates and reminders

- Send an event update or RSVP reminder to selected guests.
- Start with email; consider SMS or messaging-app integrations later, after assessing costs, consent, and regional requirements.
- Let hosts preview messages before sending.

Accounts and access

- Host account and event dashboard, with optional co-host access.
- Keep each host's events and guest data properly separated.

4. Defer until later

Keep the first release focused. Consider these only after customer validation: payments or ticketing, seating charts, vendor management, complex multi-day schedules, custom domains, native mobile apps, and automated SMS or WhatsApp messaging.

These may be useful upgrades, but add significant operational, product, or compliance complexity and should not block an initial launch.

5. Business model to test

A **pay-per-event** model fits occasional hosts better than requiring an ongoing subscription. Treat the following as pricing experiments rather than fixed commitments:

- Free draft or preview.
- One-time fee for a published event.
- Optional higher-priced upgrades, such as larger guest limits, additional designs, or more co-hosts.

Set actual prices after learning what customers value and estimating the cost to operate. Avoid locking in feature limits until those assumptions have been tested.

6. Product requirements to plan carefully

- **Privacy:** RSVP and guest information should not be exposed merely because someone has the invitation link.
- **Host control:** Hosts can update event details, manage access, and close or remove an event.
- **Reliable updates:** Make important event changes clear to guests, and support notifying them when needed.
- **International readiness:** Plan for time zones, regional date and address formats, mobile layouts, and future translations.
- **Accessibility:** Support keyboard navigation, readable contrast, and assistive technologies.
- **Messaging safety:** Give hosts control over recipients and message content; provide appropriate consent and unsubscribe handling for email.

7. Success measures

Measure whether the product solves the problem, not only whether people sign up:

- Can hosts create and publish an event without assistance?
- Do invited guests complete RSVPs?
- Do hosts return to manage their event?
- Are customers willing to pay?
- What support issues occur, and are messages successfully delivered?

8. Planning and launch sequence

- **Validate the problem:** Talk with people who recently organized different kinds of celebrations.
- **Define MVP requirements:** Agree on exact RSVP, guest-list, co-host, and messaging behavior.

- **Map the experience:** Plan host setup and dashboard flows, plus the guest invitation and RSVP flow.
- **Choose the technical approach:** Compare hosting, accounts, data storage, email delivery, and ongoing costs.
- **Test the business model:** Show the concept and pricing options to likely customers.
- **Build and pilot only after agreement:** Start with a small group of real events, then refine before wider launch.

Key risk and recommendation

The biggest risk is trying to serve every event type and every region equally well from day one. Design the product to expand broadly, but run an initial pilot with a manageable set of event types and customers.

Next planning deliverable: A product requirements document covering user flows, feature rules, privacy decisions, launch assumptions, and questions to validate before any coding begins.